

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

The background of the slide features a close-up, slightly blurred image of the national flags of India and Nepal. The Indian flag, with its saffron, white, and green horizontal stripes and the Ashoka Chakra in the center, is visible on the right side. The Nepalese flag, with its distinctive red and white triangular shapes, is visible on the left side.

INDIA-NEPAL - 1

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INDIA - NEPAL RELATIONS

- 1 Nepal shares a border of over 1850 kilometres with five Indian states- Sikkim, West Bengal, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand. It is a buffer state between India and China.
- 2 Nepal enjoys a special significance in India's foreign policy due to its geographical, historical, cultural and economic linkages.
- 3 The people of the two countries maintain close bonds through marriages and family ties, also known as 'Roti-Beti ka Rishta' (relation of food and family).
- 4 India's relations with the kingdom of Nepal can be expressed with 'Samriddha Nepal, Sukhi Nepal' (Prosperous Nepal, Happy Nepal) and 'Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas' with Nepal.
- 5 For PM Modi, Nepal has an important place in India's neighbourhood policy.



INDIA - NEPAL RELATIONS

The relations encompass multiple dimensions and can be divided into three phases:

1. Colonial period
2. Milestones in Post independence
3. Contemporary Relationship



- 1 Indo-Nepal relations got shaped under the British rule because of its imperialist policies.
- 2 British East India and Nepal fought the Anglo-Nepalese War of 1814-16 over the princely states bordering Nepal. Nepal was defeated in the war.
- 3 After the war, Treaty of Sugauli was signed in 1816 and large parts of the Nepali territory- Uttaranchal, Himachal Pradesh and Sikkim of Terai were annexed by the British Empire.
- 4 In December 1923, Britain and Nepal signed a 'Treaty of Perpetual Peace and Friendship' superseding Treaty of Sugauli of 1816 and upgraded the British resident in Kathmandu to an envoy.
- 5 Gradually, the number of Indians living and working in Nepal increased. It led to increase in Indian involvement in Nepali politics. Many Nepalese in exile participated in the Indian independence struggle.

Treaty of Sugauli



https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/File:Sugauli_treaty.jpg

WARM RELATIONS WITH NEPAL

1 India and Nepal share an open border and free movement of people. Soon after independence, India and Nepal enjoyed cordial relations.

2 In 1950, the Ranas of Nepal welcomed close relations with India. "Rana" was formerly used as a title of martial sovereignty by Rajput kings in India.



MILESTONES IN POST INDEPENDENCE

WARM RELATIONS WITH NEPAL

INDO-NEPAL TREATY OF PEACE AND FRIENDSHIP 1950

- 1 China invaded Tibet in 1949 and the rulers of Nepal feared China.
- 2 Nepal sought to forge an alliance on Foreign Affairs and Defence with India. Thus the 1950 treaty, came into being.
- 3 It is the bedrock of the special relationship that exists between India and Nepal and aims to provide everlasting peace and friendship between the two countries



MILESTONES IN POST INDEPENDENCE

WARM RELATIONS WITH NEPAL

INDO-NEPAL TREATY OF PEACE AND FRIENDSHIP 1950

ACCORDING TO THE TREATY

- 1 Respect to each other's sovereignty, territorial integrity and independence.
- 2 India and Nepal would have reciprocal treatment of Indian and Nepali citizens in matters of residence, property, business and movement.
- 3 National treatment would be given to Indian and Nepali businesses.
- 4 Nepal was to consult India before buying defence material from any other country.

NEPAL'S OBJECTIONS

- 1 Nepal considered the treaty as unequal. They feel the treaty weakens their ability to practice sovereign, foreign and security policy.
- 2 India has expressed its willingness to revive the 1950 treaty but steps are yet to be taken to address it.



CITIZENSHIP ACT

- 1 The Nepalese Citizenship Act of 1952 allows Indians to immigrate to Nepal and acquire Nepali citizenship.
- 2 A strong relationship with Nepal is essential for the vindication of India's Gujral doctrine.



TREATY OF TRADE AND TRANSIT CAME IN 1960 TO

- 1 Exchange goods between the respective territories.
- 2 Encourage collaboration in economic development.
- 3 Facilitate trade with Third World countries.



INDIRA GANDHI VISITS NEPAL

- 1 Indira Gandhi visited Nepal in 1966. Nepal in 1966, received more aid from India than any other country.
- 2 India provided military material to Nepal on the principle of non-reciprocity and allowed Nepal to import other arms and ammunitions from India necessary for its security.
- 3 95 percent of Nepal's foreign trade was with India.
- 4 Nepal wanted discussion on the following issues:
 - 1960 Treaty on Trade and Transit.
 - Impact of devaluation of the Indian rupee on Nepal's exports to India.
 - Assistance from India for Nepal's Third Plan.

However, there was no substantial decision taken on any of these issues at the meeting.



CHINA ENTERING NEPAL

- 1 In 1965, China was building a road from Kathmandu to Pokhara.
- 2 However, scholars in India remained complacent and felt that India had favourable relations with the Nepali government and China could not use it to make inroads into Nepal.



INDO-NEPAL ON MAHAKALI RIVER

1 On 12 February 1996, India and Nepal signed an agreement on the integrated development of the Mahakali river to promote cooperation in the development of water resources.

The agriculture and industrial projects were expected to flourish

2 There was also provision for irrigation of vast tract of agricultural land and flood control in Nepal and India.

3 The costs, was decided would be borne by jointly both countries.



- The contemporary relations between India and Nepal can be divided into areas in which they cooperate and areas which they have disagreements.

AREAS OF COOPERATION

- Political
- Strategic
- Defence
- Economic
- River water cooperation
- Multilateral Cooperation
- Climate Change
- Cultural
- People-to-people contacts

AREAS OF CONTENTION

- Political and Strategic
- Economic
- China Factor



POLITICAL

1 Indian government, with the help of Nepali opposition parties operating from India managed to bring a change in the Nepali political system.

2 India facilitated the transition of Nepal to democratic, republic and secular nation through the adoption of the new constitution.

3 In 2006, the citizenship law was passed in Nepal, by which four million stateless immigrants in the Terai region were granted citizenship.

4 The Eminent Persons Group (EPG) was formed in January 2016 to review various aspects of bilateral relations, including the Nepal India friendship treaty 1950.



STRATEGIC

- 1 Nepal's geo-strategic location holds immense importance for India's security architecture.
- 2 By virtue of 1950 treaty, India and Nepal jointly man the Nepal-Tibet border.
- 3 The open border between the countries helps in cementing ties between the peoples of the two countries.
- 4 The open border and 26 transit points reduce the time and cost of transportation of goods from India to Nepal



DEFENCE

1 India and Nepal have the deepest military links, with both armies awarding each other's Army chiefs the honorary ranks of General.

2 India and Nepal regularly hold military exercises known as Surya Kiran.

3 Integrated check posts have been proposed at four points on Indo-Nepal border namely-

1. Raxaul-Birganj
2. Sunauli-Bhairahawa
3. Jogibani-Biratnagar
4. Nepalganj Road –Nepalgunj

4 Aiming to improve cross border trade and transit, both countries are planning to construct border railways along all five agreed border points and the Four Integrated Check Posts (ICPs).



DEFENCE

- 5 The Gorkhas are a part of the Indian Army and the Indian government pays pension to over one lakh Nepalis.
- 6 India has played a key role in helping the Nepalese Army in its modernization through provision of equipment and training.
- 7 More than 250 training slots are provided every year for training of personnel.
- 8 Deepening security and counter-terrorism cooperation is an important priority for India. In this context, the security agencies have been proactively cooperating across a wide range of areas, including tackling illicit smuggling, arms, trafficking and fake currency.



ECONOMIC

- 1 India is the largest exporter of petroleum products to Nepal
- 2 In 2008, India decided to provide a credit line of up to 150 crore rupees to Nepal to ensure uninterrupted power supply of petroleum products and lift the ban on export of rice, maize, sugar, wheat and sucrose
- 3 India provides substantial financial and technical development assistance to Nepal by focusing on creation of infrastructure, health, water resources, education, rural and community development.
- 4 Thousands of Nepali workers who send remittances to Nepal, cross the border without any documents in search of jobs



ECONOMIC

Projects undertaken in Nepal with India's Economic Assistance:-

- 1** An MOU on Development of Railway Infrastructure at five points along the Indo-Nepal border was signed in 2010. The project is being implemented.
- 2** In June 2015, at the International Conference on Nepal's Reconstruction, India pledged a fund of \$250 million grant and \$750 million soft loan.
- 3** In 2017, eight agreements were signed between India and Nepal to boost bilateral relations covering connectivity, prevention of drug trafficking and post-earthquake construction in Nepal.



DEVELOPMENT ASSISTANCE

- 1 The Indian Prime Minister outlined the new concept of HIT to help Nepal through the development of Highways, Information and Technology and Transmission lines for Electricity
- 2 BP Koirala Institute of Health Sciences, Emergency and Trauma Centre at Bir Hospital and Manmohan Memorial Polytechnic at Biratnagar are some of the program operationalized under India's assistance.
- 3 Nepal benefits from the cheap agricultural inputs and household products from India while Indians benefit by providing better medical facilities and cheaper education in medical college across Nepalese border.
- 4 Motihari-Amlekhgunj cross-border petroleum products pipeline and Integrated Check Post at Biratnagar were inaugurated; India rebuilt over 45,000 houses under post-earthquake housing reconstruction.



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